Competition Facts — Asper Business Case Competition (ABCC)

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Validated against the official Asper website, the official **ABCC 2025 Event Guide**, and UM Today on **2026-07-31**. Items marked *(2025) / (2026)* describe those editions and serve as the baseline until the 2027 rules package is published (agenda for Feb 18–22, 2027 is still TBA on the official page).

Key data

- **Competition:** Asper Business Case Competition (ABCC) — "a three-day national-level, graduate case competition hosted at the I. H. Asper School of Business"
- **Editions:** 2026 was the fourth edition (UM Today) → **2027 is the fifth annual ABCC**
- **Dates 2027:** February 18–22, 2027; daily agenda TBA. **Note the weekday anomaly** — see below
- **Host/venue:** Drake Centre, Asper School of Business, 181 Freedman Crescent, Winnipeg (2025: prepared-case day at the Manitoba Museum; venues can vary by day)
- **Hotel 2027:** Delta Hotels Winnipeg, downtown (2025 used Hilton Garden Inn — hotel varies by year)
- **Eligibility (official wording):** "full-time, part-time, and executive MBA students, as well as Masters-level students from other management programs. Every team shall be composed of four team members."
- **Field:** 9 teams. 2025: Asper, Beedie, DeGroote, HEC Montréal, Ivey, John Molson, Levene, Memorial, Telfer. 2026: incl. first international team Babeș-Bolyai (Romania) — the 2026 winner (2nd DeGroote, 3rd HEC Montréal)
- **Contact:** aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca — Judith Jayasuriya (Instructor & Lead, Experiential Learning), Steven Harrison (Case Competition Coordinator, +1 204 396 9631)
- **Instagram:** @Asper_BCC

Typical week (2025 Event Guide)

Day	Programme
Wednesday	Arrival; 17:00 team registration + division draw (teams get neutral letters A–I)
Thursday	Prepared-case presentations (staggered slots from ~09:30); evening museum social
Friday	Boardroom case: staggered 4-h prep from ~09:30, presentations from ~14:00; Festival du Voyageur evening
Saturday	Traditional case: staggered 3-h prep from ~08:40, presentations from ~12:00; ~15:50 finalist announcement; finals 16:20–18:20; reception + awards gala (Marshall McLuhan Hall); student mixer
Sunday	Departure

The 2027 weekday question (open, and it affects flights)

Every edition in the competition's current format has started on a **Wednesday**:

Edition	Published window	Weekdays
ALCC 2023 (1st, 2-round format)	Feb 23–25, 2023	Thu → Sat
ABCC 2024 (2nd)	Feb 21–24, 2024	**Wed** → Sat
ABCC 2025 (3rd)	Feb 19–23, 2025	**Wed** → Sun

Edition	Published window	Weekdays
ABCC 2026 (4th)	Feb 18–21, 2026 (departure Feb 22)	**Wed** → Sat (dep. Sun)
ABCC 2027 (5th)	Feb 18–22, 2027 *(as published)*	**Thu** → Mon

So the published 2027 window would be the **first Thursday start since the format change** — three Wednesday starts in a row say the pattern is deliberate (weekend gala, Sunday travel). Two readings are possible and we cannot yet tell which is right:

1. **The window is exact** — registration Thu Feb 18, three competition days Fri–Sun, departure Mon Feb 22. The awards gala would fall on a Sunday.
2. **The Wednesday pattern holds** and the real week is Wed Feb 17 – Sun Feb 21, with the published range either provisional or counting days differently.

Practical consequence. Our travel envelope — arrive **Feb 16/17**, return **Feb 22/23** — covers both readings, so the booking plan is safe as it stands. **Do not book non-refundable tickets outside that envelope, and do not fix hotel nights to a specific round order, until the 2027 agenda is published.** All day-sheets in this repository assume reading 1 with the 2025 round order, and say so in place. Confirm with the organizers (question 1 of the open list below).

Format and rules (validated)

Round 1 — Prepared case (25 % of score)

- Released ~2 weeks ahead by e-mail *(2025: released Feb 5, due Feb 19, 10:00 CT — registration day)*
- Submission: **.pptx by e-mail** to aspercasecomps@umanitoba.ca, file named "[Team Name] Prepared Case"; **late submissions are placed at the bottom of the pool**
- 25-min presentation + 15-min Q&A; yellow card at 5 min, red at 1 min (both periods)
- Unlimited slides/exhibits; every member must speak
- All resources allowed, **including coach/advisor input**; contacting case-sponsor employees prohibited
- **No third-party slide templates** for the prepared case
- 2026 client: Jazz Winnipeg ("Jazz Winnipeg at a Crossroads") — pitch a radical new operational idea

Round 2 — Boardroom case (30 % of score)

- On-site prep: 4 h *(2025, 2026)*; staggered slots; deck + **one-page black-and-white executive brief** saved to a provided USB stick at a fixed pickup time
- **Protected 3 minutes:** uninterrupted recommendation using **one summary slide only — appendices blocked**; red card at 1 min
- Then **22-minute discussion** with judges, appendices accessible; yellow/red cards at 5/1 min
- Seated boardroom style, wireless keyboard/mouse provided; judges get the one-page brief in advance
- Every member must speak during the discussion (not necessarily in the protected 3 minutes)
- No coach/outside contact after release; one laptop per student; prebuilt own templates permitted; no phones/smartwatches
- 2026 client: Coal & Canary — elevate brand from premium to luxury (4 judges + company representative)

Round 3 — Traditional case (45 % of score)

- On-site prep: 3 h; staggered slots; deck to provided USB, named "[Team Name] Traditional Case"
- 20-min presentation + 10-min Q&A; yellow/red at 5/1 min (both periods)
- Unlimited slides/exhibits; every member must speak
- No coach/outside contact after release; one laptop per student; prebuilt templates permitted; no phones/smartwatches
- 2026 client: Access Credit Union — service innovations to engage young people

Final round

- Top 3 by weighted score (25/30/45); tie → higher traditional-case score advances *(2025 guide)*; the 2026/27-cycle page text expands this into a cascade — performance in the highest-weighted rounds first, then rubric-category performance by weight. Assume the cascade applies in 2027 (`handbook.md` §6)
- New judge panel; finalists escorted to a holding room; **decks frozen** (no changes)

- 20-min presentation + 15-min Q&A; yellow/red at 5/1
- Advisors may not communicate with finalist teams until after their presentation; winners announced at the gala

General rules

- Competition conducted **entirely in English**
- **PowerPoint (.pptx) only** — other software (e.g., Prezi) not permitted
- **Internet allowed during prep** — incl. login-required university databases, file sharing, and **Generative AI**
- Prebuilt own slide templates allowed (built outside prep time)
- **School anonymity: identifying your school of origin to a judge at any point = disqualification**; coach communication during presentation/Q&A = disqualification
- Cases are confidential: no reproduction/sharing; no discussing outside the competition context
- Slide clickers provided; volunteers monitor compliance; late arrival = no additional prep or presentation time; slide decks are shared with case sponsors after the event
- Dress code: **business professional**; organizers explicitly advise warm clothing, winter footwear, heavy jacket

Official judging rubric (2025 Event Guide — applied to all rounds)

Category	Weight	Judges ask
Implementation & resources	**2.5×**	Clear path to follow, with resources, time, and financial considerations?
Analysis	2.0×	Assessment/recommendation substantiated by research, logic, quant + qual analysis?
Recommendation	2.0×	Effective, clear, comprehensive, strategic fit?
Communicating effectively	1.0×	Clear, professional, compelling presentation and readable deck?
Framing the problem	1.0×	Issues wrapped into a clear, solvable summary (primary + secondary)?
Impact	1.0×	Quantitative and qualitative benefit to the organization?
Measurement, risks & mitigation	1.0×	Progress measurement and realistic risk mitigation?

Training implication: Implementation & Resources is the single heaviest category — every mock presentation must end with a concrete, resourced, costed implementation plan and KPIs.

Past cases (official PDFs)

Eleven official cases across ten clients (2023 used one client for both rounds). Six are mirrored in `01-competition/past-case-pdfs/`; the other five are linked below and must be downloaded before use.

Edition	Round	Client / case	Mirrored locally	PDF
2026	Prepared	Jazz Winnipeg at a Crossroads	—	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2026-05/abcc-2026_prepared-case.pdf
2026	Boardroom	Coal & Canary	—	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2026-05/abcc-2026_boardroom-case_final.pdf
2026	Traditional	Access Credit Union	—	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2026-04/abcc-2026_traditional-case-final.pdf
2025	Case 1 (prepared)	The Manitoba Museum	✓	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2025-03/abcc-25_case-1.pdf
2025	Case 2 (boardroom)	AROW Global	✓	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2025-03/abcc-25_case-2.pdf
2025	Case 3 (traditional)	People Corporation	✓	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2025-03/abcc-25_case-3.pdf
2024	Case 1 (prepared)	Winnipeg Art Gallery — Qaumajuq	—	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2024-08/abcc-case-1.pdf
2024	Case 2 (boardroom)	Independent Jewellers Ltd	✓	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2024-09/abcc-24_case-2.pdf
2024	Case 3 (traditional)	StandardAero	—	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2024-08/abcc-24_case-3-.pdf
2023 *(ALCC)*	Prepared	Manitoba Hydro — change-ready organization	✓	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2024-08/alcc-2023-prepared-case-final.pdf

Edition	Round	Client / case	Mirrored locally	PDF
2023 *(ALCC)*	Traditional	Manitoba Hydro — change in narrative	✓	https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2024-08/alcc-2023-traditional-case-final-2.pdf

Social program *(2025/2026)*

Manitoba Museum evening, Festival du Voyageur, scavenger hunt at The Forks (2026), reception + awards dinner at Marshall McLuhan Hall, student mixer. ~50 industry judges, 52 volunteers (2026).

Sponsors *(2026/2027 site)*

Diamond: The Associates, Stu Clark Graduate School · Room: Qualico · Supporter: Canadian Marketing Association

Sources

- Official ABCC page (2027): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/asper-business-case-competition
- Case competitions hub (past cases + 2027 wording): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/student-experience/case-competitions
- **ABCC 2025 Event Guide** (schedule, rules, rubric): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2025-01/abcc25-eventguide.pdf
- 2026 recap (fourth edition, first international team/winner): https://umtoday.ca/stories/forging-worldwide-relationships-2026-asper-business-case-competition
- ABCC 2026 sponsorship package: https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2026-04/abccsponsorpackage-2026.pdf
- Asper Case Competition Policy 2025 (note: governs **Asper's own** outbound teams, not visiting ABCC teams — context only): https://umanitoba.ca/asper/sites/asper/files/2025-06/case-competition-policy-2025.pdf

Open questions for the organizers (after registration)

1. 2027 agenda, prepared-case release date and exact submission deadline
2. Registration process/fee for an international (German) team and what it covers
3. Confirmation of eligibility for our specific student mix (Masters-level, HSBI)
4. Team roster/bio/photo requirements and deadlines; advisor registration
5. 2027 hotel block and booking code (Delta Winnipeg per website)
6. Whether the 2027 rules package changes anything vs. the 2025 Event Guide baseline — specifically any **new generative-AI clauses** (tool restrictions, disclosure duties, AI-specific confidentiality terms); the 2025 baseline simply permits GenAI
7. A **formal letter of invitation** naming all five travellers and the dates — for the Canadian border and for university travel funding

All seven are asked in one exchange by `07-logistics/registration_email_draft.md`.